

Space age

SpaceX has achieved a lot in its decade since inception. Find out exactly what and how they did it.

**Anti-fall Jyrobike**

Falling is no longer part of the learning curve while trying to learn to ride a bicycle
<http://digit.in/1qA83T7>

Who's Mind Is It Anyway - Is Artificial Intelligence Here?

Now that a machine has finally passed the Turing Test what does it mean for the world of AI?

Samir Alam
readersletters@didgit.in

The system has you. From the first mobile update in the morning to the closing sliver of light from under a laptop lid at night – you are cocooned in a gilded prison you cannot smell or touch or taste. A prison run by sentient electrons travelling at the speed of light, invisible, patient and inevitable – what some may call artificial intelligence. A bit too dramatic? Perhaps. But is it really that removed from the not so distant future?

I, Eugene Goostman

The idea of artificial intelligence and the hopes and fears that are associated with its rise are fairly prevalent in our common subconscious. Whether we imagine Judgement Day at the hands of Skynet or egalitarian totalitarianism at the hands of V.I.K.I and her army of robots – the results are the same – the equivocal displacement of humans as the dominant life forms on the planet. Some might call it the fears of a technophobic mind, others a tame prophecy. And if the recent findings at the University of Reading (U.K.) are any indication, we may have already begun fulfilling said prophecy.

In early June 2014 a historic achievement was supposedly achieved – the passing of the eternal Turing Test by a computer programme. Being hailed and derided the world over as being either the birth of artificial intelligence or a clever trickster-bot that only proved technical skill respectively, the

programme known as Eugene Goostman may soon become a name embedded in history. The programme or Eugene (to his friends) was originally created in 2001 by Vladimir Veselov from Russia and Eugene Demchenko from Ukraine. Since then it has been developed to simulate the personality and conversational patterns of a 13 year old boy and was competing against four other programmes to come out victorious.

The Turing Test was held at the world famous Royal Society in London and is considered the most comprehensively designed tests ever. The requirements for a computer programme to pass the Turing Test are simple yet difficult – the ability to convince a human being that the entity that they are conversing with is another human being at least 30 percent of the time. The result in London garnered Eugene a 33 percent success rating making it the first programme to pass the Turing Test.

The test in itself was more challenging because it engaged 300 conversations, with 30 judges or human subjects, against 5 other computer programmes in simultaneous conversations between humans and machines, over five parallel tests. Across all the instances only Eugene was able to convince 33 percent of the human judges that it was a human boy. Built with algorithms that support “conversational logic” and open-ended topics, Eugene opened up a whole

new reality of intelligent machines capable of fooling humans. With implications in the field of artificial intelligence, cyber-crime, philosophy and metaphysics, its humbling to know that Eugene is only version 1.0 and its creators are already working on something more sophisticated and advanced.

Love in the Time of Social A.I.s

So, should humanity just begin wrapping up its affairs, ready to hand over ourselves to our emerging overlords? No. Not really.



The ghost in the shell

Despite the interesting results of the Turing Test, most scientists in the field of artificial intelligence aren't that impressed. The veracity and validity of the Test itself has long been discounted as we've discovered more and more about intelligence, consciousness and the trickery of computer programmes.

In fact, the internet is already flooded with many of his unknown kin as a report by Incapsula Research showed that nearly 62 percent of all web traffic is generated by automated computer programs commonly known as bots. Some of these bots act as